

Cognizant

Back in growth after a difficult stretch, with an explicit AI builder strategy and a new engineering arm from the Belcan acquisition · www.cognizant.com

1994

Founded

351,600

Employees

\$21.1B

2025 revenue

\$28.4B

Trailing bookings

1.3x

Book-to-bill

01 Overview

Returned to what it calls the industry's winner's circle two years ahead of the target set at its Investor Day, on 7% revenue growth and 140 basis points of margin expansion. 28 large deals were signed in 2025 with total contract value up nearly 50% year over year.

Offering: Application services, digital engineering, cloud and infrastructure, and business process services. The Belcan acquisition added engineering, research and development capability aimed at a \$190B market; Thirdera made it one of ServiceNow's largest partners with Global Elite status.

Key facts

HQ: Teaneck, New Jersey

Ownership: Public (Nasdaq: CTSH)

Revenue: \$21.108B in 2025, up 7.0% reported and 6.4% at constant currency, from \$19.736B in 2024. Full-year operating margin of 16.1%, up 140 basis points. 2026 guidance of 4.0–6.5% constant-currency growth

Web: www.cognizant.com · [LinkedIn](#)

Key people: Ravi Kumar S (Chief Executive Officer) · Jatin Dalal (Chief Financial Officer)

Digital twin: Via Belcan engineering · **GenAI:** Yes (AI builder strategy)

02 Use Cases & Reported Metrics

Sector	Deployment	Reported impact	Source
Commercial performance	The AI builder strategy put into motion across 2025, with investment in talent, partnership ecosystem and AI platforms to help clients scale AI across the enterprise.	28 large deals signed in 2025 with large-deal TCV up nearly 50% year over year; Q4 included twelve deals above \$100M, two of them above \$500M	Link
Bookings & pipeline	Trailing twelve-month bookings tracked as the forward indicator of the turnaround, with Q4 bookings accelerating.	\$28.4B trailing bookings, up 5%, at a book-to-bill of approximately 1.3x; Q4 bookings up 9% year over year	Link
Engineering R&D	Acquisition of Belcan, which significantly strengthened capability in the engineering, research and development market, alongside Thirdera, which took Cognizant to ServiceNow Global Elite partner status in early 2025.	Addresses a market Cognizant sizes at \$190B	Link

03 Competitive Landscape

Other vendors in this market: Accenture · Aziro · Bain & Company · Booz Allen Hamilton · Boston Consulting Group · Capgemini · Deloitte · DXC Technology

Where it sits: Cognizant's turnaround is real but it competes on the same ground as TCS, Infosys and Wipro, and its scale sits below Accenture and Capgemini. The two things that differentiate it for an infrastructure portfolio are Belcan, which brings genuine engineering R&D rather than IT services, and its ServiceNow position — Global Elite partner status matters if a PortCo's workflow layer is ServiceNow.

04 GIP & BlackRock Connections

GIP became a wholly-owned BlackRock subsidiary in October 2024 and now operates as BlackRock's dedicated infrastructure-investment arm. Stakes below are standard institutional/index-fund positions unless otherwise noted.

Entity	Possible connection
Global Infrastructure Partners	No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. Most plausible route in is a PortCo's existing application or infrastructure managed-services contract; Belcan is the part worth testing for asset-level engineering work.
BlackRock	No publicly disclosed operating relationship; standard index holdings of CTSH only.

05 Sentiment

Customer: Deal metrics are the strongest available proxy and they point the right way: large-deal total contract value up nearly 50%, two mega deals above \$500M in Q4, and book-to-bill at roughly 1.3x. Cognizant publishes almost no attributable client outcomes, so the read rests on commercial signals rather than evidenced delivery.

What supports the story

- Growth restored to 7% with 140 basis points of margin expansion — both moving the right way at once
- Book-to-bill of approximately 1.3x on \$28.4B of trailing bookings is a healthy forward indicator
- Belcan brings engineering R&D capability rather than more IT services headcount

What to pressure-test

- 2026 guidance of 4.0–6.5% constant currency implies deceleration from 2025's 6.4%
- Scale sits well below Accenture and Capgemini in a market where scale drives ecosystem access
- Highly exposed to the same offshore labour-arbitrage model that AI delivery is compressing

Employee: Headcount grew by 14,800 to 351,600 and voluntary attrition in tech services fell to 13.9% from 15.9% a year earlier — both point to a stabilising workforce after a turbulent period.

Sources: Cognizant public filings/website, company fact sheets, Wikipedia, PitchBook/Crunchbase/Datanyze/BuiltIn profiles, Glassdoor employer reviews, vendor case studies and press releases as of Sept. 2026. Figures marked "est." or "not disclosed" are third-party estimates or unavailable — not company-confirmed — validate in diligence. Part of the Physical AI / Industrial AI for Critical Infrastructure market landscape.